Press release for the march

Metro Manila Delivery Riders to Hold Labor Day Safety March on May 1

United Delivery Riders of Metro Manila (UDRMM) calls on FoodTiger and government agencies to address rainy-season safety risks and unfair delivery targets.

MANILA, PHILIPPINES — April 28, 2026 *— On May 1 (Labor Day), hundreds of food delivery workers across Metro Manila will organize a peaceful motorcade and public assembly titled "Safe Delivery, Fair Delivery."*

Organized by the United Delivery Riders of Metro Manila (UDRMM), a worker-led union, the march aims to raise public awareness about the dangerous working conditions delivery riders face during severe weather. It also serves as a formal call for dialogue with the management of international platform company FoodTiger and the Department of Labor and Employment (DOLE).

The assembly will take place ahead of UN Global Road Safety Week to highlight how sudden floods and extreme weather threaten workers' lives. Recently, FoodTiger reduced the payment riders receive per delivery while keeping the same delivery-time targets during both the dry and rainy seasons.

When heavy rains hit Metro Manila, flooded roads and gridlock traffic make fast travel impossible. Riders who arrive late risk bad ratings from customers, fewer orders, or sudden account deactivation by the platform's algorithm.

> *"When streets are flooded, our riders have to choose between risking their physical safety and losing their daily income,"-UDRMM. "No delivery is worth a rider's safety. FoodTiger has a strong profit margin in the country, and we are not asking them to shut down. We are simply asking for fair pay, realistic delivery times when it rains, and respect for our basic safety."*

Key Evidence and Working Conditions

UDRMM emphasizes that the challenges faced by delivery riders are supported by recent research on Metro Manila platform work:

- ***Low and Unstable Income:*** *A Department of Labor and Employment (DOLE) study of 130 delivery riders in Metro Manila showed that nearly half earned between ₱10,001 and ₱20,000 per month, with 68% working over eight hours a day and 48% working seven days a week (Sta Ana et al., 2023).*
- ***High Safety Hazards:*** *40% of surveyed riders reported work-related injuries, while riders must independently pay for fuel, mobile data, and vehicle repairs out of their own pockets.*
- ***Lack of Fair Protections:*** *A 2025 Fairwork Philippines study found insufficient evidence that major platforms guarantee that workers earn the local minimum wage after covering work expenses.*

The Union's Key Demands and Calls to Action

During the May 1 mobilization, UDRMM will highlight four main appeals:

1. ***To FoodTiger Management:***
   Meet with UDRMM and labor authorities to establish weather-adjusted delivery targets, provide a bad-weather safety allowance, and remove unfair rating penalties during heavy rains.
2. ***To Customers and the Public:***
   Show empathy for riders during severe weather. The union asks customers to support the slogan: "Do not give a 1-star rating during a storm" and sign the online petition.
3. ***To Non-Union Riders and Their Families:***
   Join UDRMM to build collective bargaining strength. The union provides mutual support, privacy protection, and a collective voice for all delivery riders across platforms.
4. ***Launch of the Campaign Crowdfunding Fund:***
   To remain independent, UDRMM is launching a community crowdfunding fund to provide riders with waterproof helmet stickers, safety vests, and emergency legal support.

Campaign Information and Resources

- *Official Website:*
- *Petition & Policy Brief: Available for download on the campaign website.*
- *Social Media: @UDRMM*

About UDRMM

The United Delivery Riders of Metro Manila (UDRMM) is a worker-led labor union created and managed by delivery riders across Metro Manila. Supported by local labor advocates and NGOs, UDRMM works to protect the rights, safety, and welfare of platform delivery workers.